

EEF Meeting Minutes, Thursday April 29, 2021

Erlang Ecosystem Foundation, Minutes of a Regular Meeting of the Board of Directors Meeting #48, April 29, 2021

A regular meeting of the Erlang Ecosystem Foundation was held over group conference call (Zoom). The meeting began at 16:05 UTC.

Attendance

The following members of the board of directors were present (10/11): Richard Carlsson, Francesco Cesarini, Maxim Fedorov, Kenneth Lundin, Frédéric Trottier-Hébert, Peer Stritzinger, Sebastian Stollo, Bryan Paxton, Miriam Pena Villanueva, and Alistair Woodman.

Agenda Items

1. Vote of the minutes of the previous meeting.

RESOLVED, that the Erlang Ecosystem Foundation approve the minutes as presented as representing a true and accurate record of the board meeting #47 held on April 15, 2021. Unanimously approved.

2. Intermediate actions:

1. Alistair signed us up for the D&O insurance.

3. Sebastian reported some intermediate actions regarding our banking status. He has filed an application for a credit card (to save money and because it is safer than using our ATM card to pay for services), we are at the “platinum tier” with Bank of America (which means we get lower fees, some free money transfers etc). Membership update: Annual Supporting members: 127 (unchanged), Lifetime Supporting members: 13 (+1), Basic members: 662 (+13)

4. No unanimous consent votes scheduled

5. Continuity of Bryan's work: Bryan has really acted in two different roles, “sysops” and “community management” - we need to think about whether we should try to get someone to do both of these roles, or if we would like to split it into two persons. Bryan will write a job description of what he has been doing, to make it easier to make a decision / understand what type of person we are after. Francesco

pointed out the benefit of having a “community manager” (from his experience with the Erlang Industrial User Group), a single point of contact, that provides continuity and someone that coordinates efforts within the EEF. Francesco also suggested that it may be possible to sign up a junior person for a year and help them get effective.

6. Bryan presented a proposal (attached) to sponsor the SpawnFest. The goal is to show that EEF spends serious money in the community and that EEF is a major sponsor of SpawnFest (which is very popular). The request is for up to USD \$3000 (to sponsor prizes in the form of Amazon gift cards for participants and for judges), and during the discussion the request to also provide membership as prizes was dropped.

RESOLVED, that the Erlang Ecosystem Foundation approve the sponsorship of SpawnFest prizes, as laid out in the proposal, for up to \$3000. Unanimously approved.

7. Marketing update: the team from Nayra will be visiting next board call and give us an update.
8. Quick (not much time left in the meeting) update on stipend work: Peer: the floating point optimization is done, Thomas is working on testing and benchmarking. The ARM64 JIT is progressing well, initial tests show 2x performance improvement (even without any optimizations or tweaks). ARM32 is also making good progress. ROSIE still getting bootstrapped. Conference stipends: Miriam: reaching out to students and universities to offer tickets.
9. Alistair declared the meeting adjourned at 17:04 UTC.

Dated April 29, 2021

Secretary of the meeting: _____ Sebastian Strollo

Attachments: SpawnFest sponsorship proposal (three pages)

SpawnFest 2021 sponsorship proposal



What?

SpawnFest is an annual 48 hour online software development contest in which teams from around the world get exactly one weekend to create the best BEAM-based applications they can. The ideals behind spawnfest are fun, learning, and to help connect sponsors and players for jobs. In addition, long term projects can fall out of this, which is excellent for the ecosystem.

The intention behind this proposal is to gain sponsorship by the EEF in spawnfest as a platinum sponsor.

1. Platinum sponsorship in the form of 3000 USD worth of Amazon gift card(s)
 - a. At least 1500 is up for grabs by winning players. It is up to a designated team player(s) how to divide this up within a team and not the foundation's burden.
 - b. A portion might go to judges who have only ever once gotten a gift by a sponsor. They arguably do more work than any team or player.
2. ~~Platinum sponsorship in the form of one lifetime EEF membership for each player on a winning team~~
 - a. ~~Each team can have a maximum of 4 players. If we get the same numbers we did last year, we would be giving around 20 lifetime memberships out~~
 - b. ~~We do not anticipate more than the last year, we hope for double. That would mean a maximum of 40 lifetime memberships.~~

Spawnfest would add EEF logo(s) to the site and market EEFs sponsorship through various social channels. We would also reach out to all working groups for project ideas this year in an effort to help startup teams and players.

Who?

Spawnfest is being driven this year by a new set of organizers.

- Pablo Costas Sánchez
 - Klarna
 - Education WG member
 - Building and Packaging WG Member
- Paulo F. Oliveira
 - Miniclip
 - Active contributor to EEF software projects
 - Annual supporting member
- Filipe Varjão
 - 2600hz
 - Education WG member
- Bryan Paxton
 - Erlang Solutions
 - Board Member
 - Active contributor to EEF software projects
 - Annual supporting member
 - Building and Packaging WG member
 - Marketing WG co-chair

Why?

From all my experiences within the BEAM community, everyone looks forward to spawnfest, as players or onlookers. Last year was the biggest turn out ever in the history of spawnfest and we're aiming for an even bigger turn out this year. In order to achieve a bigger turn out we believe more sponsors and more prizes is the way to go.

EEF being a platinum sponsor, and perhaps what will be the biggest sponsor is no small thing. Spawnfest would indeed make a lot of noise about this; as can the EEF itself.

It's in line with EEF goals. Namely, connect companies with engineers, especially less experienced and / or newer engineers. Further, a job fair for sponsors and players prior to the event is one our agenda. Said job fair could be exclusively provided by the EEF utilizing toucan, which was hands down a huge success and further drove up our membership numbers.

We are also seeking lots of new project ideas to help players start up. We will be reaching out to all working groups for project ideas to offer players.

How?

Head on over to <https://spawnfest.org/> go to the sponsors section and click the form link or just go here : <https://forms.gle/HKHghJmYhgA3eN9B6>

When?

The event will be held Sept. 18th and 19th (approximately 4 months from now). This gives the organizers plenty of time to come up with new ideas on how to promote the event and its sponsors. Further, how to get more players and project ideas to come to fruition. Specifically, we want to see projects that sustain or at least can be picked up by others after the event.

Where?

The event is held online and globally available.